

User Research Summary

Project: MoFlow: Smart Recurring Bill Payments Platform

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Executive Summary

This User Research Summary presents the findings from the discovery phase of the MoFlow Smart Recurring Bill Payments Platform. The research was conducted to better understand the behaviours, challenges, motivations, and expectations of individuals and small business owners who regularly use mobile money for recurring financial obligations.

The insights gathered informed the product vision, business requirements, user personas, customer journey, and feature prioritisation. The research identified that users experience significant friction in manually managing recurring payments, often leading to missed due dates, financial penalties, service interruptions, and unnecessary administrative effort.

The findings support the development of a mobile-first platform that simplifies recurring payment management through automation, timely reminders, payment tracking, and a centralized dashboard.

Portfolio Note: This document is based on a hypothetical research exercise created to demonstrate Business Analysis practices and does not represent findings from a production research study.

Research Objectives

The research sought to answer the following questions:

- How do users currently manage recurring mobile money payments?
- What challenges do users experience with manual recurring payments?
- What motivates users to adopt an automated payment solution?
- Which features provide the greatest value to users?
- What concerns might prevent adoption?
- What opportunities exist to improve the recurring payment experience?

Research Scope

The study focused on recurring personal and small business payments, including:

- Electricity bills

- Water bills
- Internet subscriptions
- Television subscriptions
- School fees
- House rent
- Insurance premiums
- Loan repayments
- Business utility payments

The research considered the complete customer journey from payment planning through payment confirmation and ongoing management.

Research Methodology

For this Business Analysis case study, a mixed-method research approach was assumed to capture both qualitative and quantitative insights.

Qualitative Research

- Semi-structured user interviews
- Stakeholder interviews
- Competitor analysis
- User journey analysis
- Persona development

Quantitative Research

- Online user surveys
- Feature prioritisation questionnaire
- Payment behaviour analysis
- Usage trend review

Target Participants

The research focused on representative user groups that regularly make recurring payments.

User Group	Description
Salaried Professionals	Employees who manage recurring household expenses using mobile money.
Small Business Owners	Entrepreneurs responsible for recurring operational payments such as utilities and internet services.

Parents	Individuals responsible for recurring education and household payments.
University Students	Students making recurring accommodation, internet, and subscription payments.

Research Assumptions

The following assumptions guided the research:

- Participants regularly use mobile money services.
- Participants have recurring monthly financial obligations.
- Smartphone ownership is common among the target audience.
- Users value convenience, reliability, and security.
- Automated recurring payments are not yet widely adopted.

These assumptions were established for the purpose of this portfolio case study.

Key Research Findings

Finding 1: Manual Payment Management Creates Friction

Most users currently remember payment dates manually or rely on personal reminders such as calendars, notes, or messaging apps.

Impact

- Missed due dates
- Increased stress
- Repetitive manual effort

Finding 2: Users Frequently Forget Payment Deadlines

Participants reported occasionally forgetting payment dates, particularly when managing multiple recurring obligations.

Impact

- Late payment penalties
- Service interruptions
- Financial inconvenience

Finding 3: Users Want Greater Visibility

Participants expressed difficulty tracking upcoming payments and reviewing completed transactions.

Desired Outcome

A centralized dashboard showing:

- Upcoming payments
- Completed payments
- Payment history
- Payment status

Finding 4: Users Value Automation

Participants preferred automating recurring payments instead of repeating the same payment process every month.

Desired Features

- Automatic recurring payments
- Flexible payment schedules
- Easy editing of payment plans

Finding 5: Security Strongly Influences Adoption

Users indicated that they would only trust an automated payment platform if it clearly communicated security measures.

Key Expectations

- Secure authentication
- Reliable payment processing
- Transaction confirmations
- Transparent privacy practices

Finding 6: Payment Notifications Increase Confidence

Participants wanted proactive reminders before payments were processed and confirmation after successful transactions.

Preferred Notifications

- Upcoming payment reminders
- Payment success notifications
- Failed payment alerts

User Pain Points

The research identified several recurring challenges.

Pain Point	Business Impact
Forgetting payment dates	Missed payments and customer dissatisfaction
Manual payment repetition	Reduced efficiency
Poor visibility into upcoming bills	Financial uncertainty
Limited payment history	Difficulty tracking expenses
Lack of reminders	Increased payment failures
Concerns about payment security	Lower adoption rates

User Needs

Based on the findings, users require a solution that enables them to:

- Automate recurring payments.
- Schedule payments in advance.
- Receive payment reminders.
- Track payment history.
- Manage multiple recurring obligations.
- Pause, edit, or cancel payment schedules.
- Receive immediate payment confirmations.
- Access a secure and reliable payment platform.

Product Opportunities

The research identified several opportunities to create customer and business value.

High Priority Opportunities

- Recurring payment scheduling
- Automatic payment execution
- Payment reminders
- Centralized payment dashboard
- Searchable payment history
- Payment status tracking

Medium Priority Opportunities

- Spending summaries
- Bill categorisation
- Calendar view
- Multiple mobile money accounts

Future Opportunities

- Budget planning
- AI-powered spending insights
- Financial goal tracking
- Family account management
- Business account management

Research Insights

Several strategic insights emerged during the discovery process.

Insight 1

Users value convenience more than additional financial features.

Insight 2

Reducing anxiety around missed payments is a primary customer need.

Insight 3

Trust is a major driver of product adoption.

Insight 4

Users expect transparency throughout the payment process.

Insight 5

Simple user experiences encourage greater engagement than feature-heavy interfaces.

Product Recommendations

Based on the research findings, the following recommendations are proposed.

Product

- Prioritise recurring payment automation.
- Simplify payment scheduling.
- Design a clean and intuitive dashboard.
- Provide flexible reminder options.

- Support easy payment schedule management.

User Experience

- Reduce onboarding complexity.
- Provide clear payment confirmations.
- Minimise the number of steps required to schedule payments.
- Ensure accessibility for users with varying technical proficiency.

Business

- Encourage recurring payment adoption through onboarding guidance.
- Monitor payment success and customer satisfaction.
- Continuously collect user feedback after product launch.
- Measure feature adoption using product analytics.

Influence on Business Requirements

The research findings directly informed several key requirements for MoFlow, including:

- Recurring payment scheduling functionality.
- Configurable payment reminders.
- Dashboard for recurring payment management.
- Payment history and receipts.
- Secure authentication and authorization.
- Flexible schedule editing.
- Real-time payment status updates.
- Notification preferences.

These insights were incorporated into the Business Requirements Document (BRD), user stories, acceptance criteria, and future product roadmap.

Limitations

As this is a portfolio case study, the research findings are illustrative and intended to demonstrate a structured Business Analysis approach. No proprietary user data or production research was used.

Future iterations of the product should validate these assumptions through live customer interviews, usability testing, analytics, and continuous feedback loops.

Conclusion

The user research confirmed a clear need for a streamlined solution that simplifies recurring mobile money payments. Users consistently expressed a desire for greater convenience, reliability, visibility, and control over their financial obligations.

The findings provide a strong evidence base for the development of MoFlow and ensure that product decisions remain grounded in user needs rather than assumptions. By translating research insights into actionable requirements, the project establishes a user-centred foundation for product design, development, and continuous improvement.